**At This Table**

Every covenant God ever made came with a test. Not to trap His people, but to make their faith visible. Abraham had Moriah (would he sacrifice his only son?). Israel had the manna, gathered daily (would they trust God for every provision?). And the New Covenant has a test too, scheduled every week, with the examination written into the command itself:

"*A person should examine himself first, and in this way let him eat the bread and drink of the cup.*" (1 Corinthians 11:28)

So, this table is not only a memorial. It is the covenant meal asking the covenant question: is the faith you professed at the door still real at the table?

Consider where this bread and cup come from. The night before the cross, Jesus knelt in Gethsemane and prayed, "*not what I will, but what you will.*" In that one prayer, Jesus obeyed God's will in every sense that we can understand.

The cross was *decreed* — Peter would later say Jesus was handed over "by the predetermined plan and foreknowledge of God." The cross was *carried out* by men breaking every command God ever gave. And the cross was *desired* — the supreme expression of a God who "does not wish for any to perish." Sovereign will, moral will, and the heart behind both — all of it converging on one cup that Jesus chose to drink.

That is the obedience of faith in the Lord's own words: *not what I will, but what you will.* And it is what we are being shaped into, every time we come here.

So how should we come?

Not asking, "Am I worthy?" No one at this table is worthy. That is why there is a table. We were "made holy through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ once for all." Mercy comes first with our God. Always.

Come instead asking the examination's real question: *Am I coming in faith and love, or in pretense and grudge?* Is there a brother I have not forgiven? A command I have been quietly disobeying? A good I have been keeping back from God, the way that Saul kept back the best of the flock? Recall that Samuel rebuked Saul, saying, "to obey is better than sacrifice".

Be instead like the man we now remember... the author of our faith.

Although he was God's only begotten son, he learned obedience through the things he suffered. And by being perfected in this way, he became the source of eternal salvation to all who obey him. (Hebrews 5:8–9)

Bring your living sacrifice here. Lay yourself down on the altar of obedience of faith. And then eat, not as someone who has earned a seat, but as someone who has been given one, and who answers that gift the only way faith can: *not what I will, but what you will*.

Examine yourself. Then eat the bread and drink the cup.